

John 1:1

In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

Malachi 3:6a

For I am the LORD, I change not;

The King James version of the Bible uses for its translation what is referred to as “Early Modern English” (circa late 15th century to mid-to-late 17th century). While the definitions and common usages of those words have remained the same since that time the English language has changed significantly since then such that it is now comparatively referred to as “Modern English.”

This document will present a minuscule sample of the evidence of those changes in a concise, comparative format. Due to a conscious attempt of the author to minimize and/or avoid solicitation and prejudice the reader will be required to observe carefully, research, and come to their own conclusions. A very small amount of guidance will be provided in an attempt to stimulate the readers curiosity.

Information from some sources has been removed (eg. example sentences) and/or reformatted to both fit this format more elegantly and to be easier to digest. Below is a table of all the tools cited and used and the reader is encouraged to explore each resource individually for more information and especially for clarification on the acronyms, symbols, and styles particular to each resource which will not be explained in this document.

It is assumed that the reader already understands basic English language structure (eg. noun, verb, intransitive) and also common Bible study reference styles such as Strong's numbers for both Hebrew and Greek (eg. H4767, G190), Strong's definitions (eg. the meaning of an “X” symbol), and at least one style of Bible book, chapter, and verse shorthand notation (eg. Genesis 7:7-9).

The one resource used to create this document that is not widely available (custom Bible search tool) can easily be replaced by any number of freely available alternatives including but not limited to other resources in the table.

Resource	Purpose
Merriam-Webster Dictionary 2023 www.merriam-webster.com	Modern English definitions
Noah Webster's 1828 Dictionary ISBN: 978-0-912498-03-4	Early Modern English definitions
English-Hebrew/Greek Interlinear KJV Bible www.blueletterbible.org	Hebrew/Greek word identification, Strong's definitions, Hebrew/Greek word usage counts, Hebrew/Greek word spellings and pronunciations
Strong's comprehensive concordance of the Bible ISBN: 0-529-06334-4	Hebrew/Greek word identification, Strong's definitions, Hebrew/Greek word usage counts, Hebrew/Greek word spellings and pronunciations
“Bible search tool” Custom software written by me that searches and parses the King James version Bible (Cambridge) in a variety of ways.	English word counts, Verse references

Genesis 1:28

And God blessed them, and God said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and **replenish** (H4390) the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing that moveth upon the earth.

NOTE: the English word “replenish” appears twice in the Bible and this is the first occurrence. The English word “replenished” appears five times in the Bible. Neither replenish/replenished appears in the New Testament.

Replenish & Replenished: H4390 (7x)	Strong's definition
 (maw-lay')	מָלָא mālâ', maw-lay'; or מָלֵא mālâ'; (Esther 7:5), a primitive root; to fill or (intransitively) be full of, in a wide application (literally and figuratively):—accomplish, confirm, consecrate, be at an end, be expired, be fenced, fill, fulfil, (be, become, × draw, give in, go) full(-ly, -ly set, tale), (over-) flow, fulness, furnish, gather (selves, together), presume, replenish, satisfy, set, space, take a (hand-) full, have wholly.

[Merriam-Webster online 2023:](#)

Replenish transitive verb

1 : to fill or build up again

2 a : to fill with persons or animals

b : to fill with inspiration or power : NOURISH

c archaic : to supply fully : PERFECT

Example Sentences

- An efficient staff of workers replenished the trays of appetizers almost as quickly as guests emptied them.
- He replenished his supply of wood in preparation for the winter.
- Drink this—you need to replenish your fluids after your hike.
- plants that replenish soil nutrients

[Noah Webster 1828:](#)

REPLENISH, v. t.

[Norm. replener, to fill; It. Riempire; L. re and plenus, full.]

1. To fill; to stock with numbers or abundance. The magazines are *replenished* with corn. The springs are *replenished* with water.

Multiply and *replenish* the earth. Gen. I.

2. To finish; to complete. [*Not in use.*] *Shak.*

REPLENISH, v. i. To recover former fullness. *Bacon.*

Comments

Using the modern English dictionary and applying it to scripture means that we can form the hypothesis that the Earth was populated before the first man and woman were created (Genesis 1:27,28).

Psalms 37:14

The wicked have drawn out the sword, and have bent their bow, to cast down the poor and needy, and to slay such as be of upright **conversation** (H1870).

NOTE: the English word “conversation” appears 20 times in the Bible and this is the first occurrence.

Conversation: H1870 (2x) דֶּרֶךְ (deh'-rek)	Strong's definition דֶּרֶךְ derek, deh'-rek; from H1869; a road (as trodden); figuratively, a course of life or mode of action, often adverb:—along, away, because of, by, conversation, custom, (east-) ward, journey, manner, passenger, through, toward, (high-) (path-) way(-side), whither(-soever).
Conversation: G390 (2x) ἀναστρέφω (an-as-tref'-o)	Strong's definition ἀναστρέφω anastréphō, an-as-tref'-o; from G303 and G4762; to overturn; also to return; by implication, to busy oneself, i.e. remain, live:—abide, behave self, have conversation, live, overthrow, pass, return, be used.
Conversation: G391 (12x) ἀναστροφή (an-as-trof-ay')	Strong's definition ἀναστροφή anastrophé, an-as-trof-ay'; from G390; behavior:—conversation.
Conversation: G4175 (1x) πολίτευμα (pol-it'-yoo-mah)	Strong's definition πολίτευμα políteuma, pol-it'-yoo-mah; from G4176; a community, i.e. (abstractly) citizenship (figuratively):—conversation.
Conversation: G4176 (1x) πολιτεύομαι (pol-it-yoo'-om-ahee)	Strong's definition †πολιτεύομαι politeúomai, pol-it-yoo'-om-ahee; middle voice of a derivative of G4177; to behave as a citizen (figuratively):—let conversation be, live.
Conversation: G5158 (1x) τρόπος (trop'-os)	Strong's definition τρόπος τρόπος, trop'-os; from the same as G5157; a turn, i.e. (by implication) mode or style (especially with preposition or relative prefix as adverb, like); figuratively, deportment or character:—(even) as, conversation, (+ like) manner, (+ by any) means, way.

Conversation noun

1 a (1) : oral exchange of sentiments, observations, opinions, or ideas

(2) : an instance of such exchange : TALK

b : an informal discussion of an issue by representatives of governments, institutions, or groups
conversations among the senators

c : an exchange similar to conversation

2 obsolete : CONDUCT, BEHAVIOR

Example Sentences

- Do you remember our conversation about that new movie?
- We got into a long conversation about his behavior.
- They were engaged in a lengthy conversation about politics.
- The topic came up in conversation.

Noah Webster 1828:

CONVERSATION, n.

1. General course of manners; behavior; deportment; especially as it respects morals.

Let your *conversation* be as becometh the gospel. Phil i.

Be ye holy in all manner of *conversation*. 1 Pet. i.

2. A keeping company; familiar intercourse; intimate fellowship or association; commerce in social life. Knowledge of men and manners is best acquired by *conversation* with the best company.

3. Intimate and familiar acquaintance; as a *conversation* with books, or other object.

4. Familiar discourse; general intercourse of sentiments; chat; unrestrained talk; opposed to a formal conference.

What I mentioned in *conversation* was not a new thought. *Swift*.

[This is now the most general use of the word.]

Comments

Note the exhaustive list of Hebrew and Greek words and definitions that were translated to the English word “conversation.” That is intentional so the reader can more easily compare each source. Also noteworthy, according to the modern English dictionary the only definition (2) that appears to resemble Biblical usage is stated as being “obsolete¹.”

¹ [Merriam-Websters 2023](#): “Obsolete” definition 1a: “no longer in use or no longer useful”

Job 3:12

Why did the knees **prevent** (H6923) me? or why the breasts that I should suck?

NOTE: the English word “prevent” appears 7 times in the Bible and this is the first occurrence.

Prevent/Prevented: H6923 (14x) קָדַם (kaw-dam')	Strong's definition קָדַם qâdam, kaw-dam'; a primitive root; to project (one self), i.e. precede; hence, to anticipate, hasten, meet (usually for help):—come (go, (flee)) before, disappoint, meet, prevent.
Prevent: G5348 (1x) φθάνω (fthan'-o)	Strong's definition φθάνω phthánō, fthan'-o; apparently a primary verb; to be beforehand, i.e. anticipate or precede; by extension, to have arrived at:—(already) attain, come, prevent.
Prevented: G4399 (1x) προφθάνω (prof-than'-o)	Strong's definition προφθάνω prophthánō, prof-than'-o; from G4253 and G5348; to get an earlier start of, i.e. anticipate:—prevent.
Prevented: G5348 (1x) φθάνω (fthan'-o)	Strong's definition φθάνω phthánō, fthan'-o; apparently a primary verb; to be beforehand, i.e. anticipate or precede; by extension, to have arrived at:—(already) attain, come, prevent.

[Merriam-Webster online 2023:](#)

Prevent transitive verb

- 1 : to keep from happening or existing
- 2 : to hold or keep back : HINDER, STOP —often used with from
- 3 : to deprive of power or hope of acting or succeeding
- 4 archaic a: to be in readiness for (something, such as an occasion)
 - b: to meet or satisfy in advance
 - c: to act ahead of
 - d: to go or arrive before

intransitive verb

: to interpose an obstacle

Example Sentences

- Seatbelts in cars often prevent serious injuries.
- Can exercise and a healthy diet prevent heart disease?
- The accident could have been prevented.
- He grabbed my arm to prevent me from falling.

Noah Webster 1828:

PREVENT, v. t. [It. Prevenire; Sp. Fr. Prevenir; L. praevenio, supra.]

1. To go before; to precede.

I *prevented* the dawning of the morning, and cried. Ps cxix

2. To precede, as something unexpected or unsought.

The days of my affliction *prevented* me. Job xxx 2 Sam. xxxii [6, 19]

3. To go before; to precede; to favor by anticipation or by hindering distress or evil.

The God of my mercy shall *prevent* me. PS lix.

Comments

Take note of the prioritization of definition sources of each resource. Upon more thorough inspection you may notice that there is a common theme to each resource.

Acts 5:34

Then stood there up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a **doctor** (G3547) of the law, had in reputation among all the people, and commanded to put the apostles forth a little space;

Doctor/Doctors: G3547 (2x)	Strong's definition
Νομοδιδάσκαλος (nom-od-id-as'-kal-os)	νομοδιδάσκαλος nomodidáskalos, nom-od-id-as'-kal-os; from G3551 and G1320; an expounder of the (Jewish) law, i.e. a Rabbi:—doctor (teacher) of the law.

Doctors: G1320 (1x)	Strong's definition
Διδάσκαλος (did-as'-kal-os)	διδάσκαλος didáskalos, did-as'-kal-os; from G1321; an instructor (genitive case or specially):—doctor, master, teacher.

[Merriam-Webster online 2023:](#)

Doctor noun

- 1 a Christianity : an eminent theologian declared a sound expounder of doctrine by the Roman Catholic Church
b : a learned or authoritative teacher
c : a person who has earned one of the highest academic degrees (such as a PhD) conferred by a university
d : a person awarded an honorary doctorate (such as an LLD or Litt D) by a college or university
- 2 a : a person skilled or specializing in healing arts
b : MEDICINE MAN
- 3 a : material added (as to food) to produce a desired effect
b : a blade (as of metal) for spreading a coating or scraping a surface
- 4 : a person who restores, repairs, or fine-tunes things

Doctor transitive verb

- 1 a : to give medical treatment to
b : to restore to good condition : REPAIR
- 2 a : to adapt or modify for a desired end by alteration or special treatment
b : to alter deceptively

Doctor intransitive verb

- 1 : to practice medicine
- 2 dialect : to take medicine

Example Sentences

Noun

- He needed medicine but refused to go to a doctor.
- She was under doctor's orders not to return to work.
- I saw her at the doctor's last week.
- How long will you be at the doctor?
- Most of the faculty members at this college are doctors in their fields.
- Dr. Smith, can you explain the exam requirements again?

Verb

- They were accused of doctoring the company's financial records.
- a doctored photo of the actress
- I think somebody doctored the punch.
- He had time to doctor his wounds.
- She doctored the sick child until the physician arrived.

Noah Webster 1828:

DOCTOR, n. [L. from doceo, to teach]

1. A teacher

There stood up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a *doctor* of the law. Acts v.

2. One who has passed all the degrees of a faculty, and is empowered to practice and teach it, as a *doctor* in divinity, in physic, in law; or according to modern usage, a person who has received the highest degree in a faculty. The degree of *doctor* is conferred by universities and colleges, as an honorary mark of literary distinction. It is also conferred on physicians, as a professional degree.

3. A learned man; a man skilled in a profession; a man of erudition. *Dryden. Digby.*

4. A physician; one whose occupation is to cure diseases.

5. The title, *doctor*, is given to a certain fathers of the church whose opinions are received as authorities, and in the Greek church, it is given to a particular officer who interprets the scriptures. *Encyc. Doctors Commons*, the college of civilians in London.

DOCTOR, v. t.

1. To apply medicines for the cure of diseases [*A popular use of this word, but not elegant.*]

DOCTOR, v. i.

1. To practice physic. [*Not elegant.*]

Comments

Note how the modern English dictionary directly associates Christianity with the Roman Catholic church (1a). Additionally, it is stated that those theologians are “eminent.”¹

¹ [Merriam-Websters definition:](#)

eminent adjective

1 : exhibiting eminence especially in standing above others in some quality or position : PROMINENT

2 : standing out so as to be readily perceived or noted : CONSPICUOUS

3 : jutting out : PROJECTING

Genesis 2:24

Therefore shall a man leave his **father** (H1) and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.

Comments

This one is far more complicated than it may initially appear and to document all of it here is beyond the scope of this document. Certain words have been highlighted in red to draw your attention and to elicit careful consideration.

Merriam-Webster online 2023:

Father noun

1 a (1) : a male parent

(2) : a man who has begotten a child

capitalized

(1) : GOD sense 1

(2) : the first person of the Trinity (see TRINITY sense 1)

GOD sense 1:

1 God : the supreme or **ultimate reality**: such as

a : the **Being** perfect in power, wisdom, and goodness who is worshipped (as in **Judaism, Christianity, Islam, and Hinduism**) as creator and ruler of the universe

Throughout the patristic and medieval periods, Christian theologians taught that God created the universe ...—
Jame Schaefer

... the **Supreme Being** or God, the personal form of the **Ultimate Reality**, is conceived by Hindus as having **various aspects**. —Sunita Pant Bansal

b Christian Science : the incorporeal **divine Principle** ruling over all as eternal Spirit : **infinite Mind**

Merriam-Websters 2023: definition “ultimate reality”:

Ultimate Reality noun often capitalized U&R

: something that is the supreme, final, and fundamental power in all reality

ultimate reality in **Judaism, Christianity, and Islam** is God

Merriam-Websters 2023: definition “supreme being”:

Supreme Being noun

: GOD sense 1

Merriam-Websters 2023: definition “principle”:

principle noun

4 capitalized **Christian Science** : a divine principle : GOD

TRINITY sense 1

1 : the unity of Father, Son, and Holy Spirit as three persons in one Godhead according to **Christian dogma**

Merriam-Websters 2023: definition “dogma”:

dogma noun

1 a : something held as an established **opinion**

b : a code of such **tenets**

c : a **point of view** or **tenet** put forth as authoritative **without adequate grounds**

2 : a doctrine or body of doctrines concerning faith or morals formally stated and **authoritatively proclaimed by a church**

Merriam-Websters 2023: definition “tenet”:

tenet noun

: a principle, belief, or doctrine **generally held to be true**

especially : one held in common by members of an **organization, movement, or profession**

Noah Webster 1828:

(to save space, the etymology section, some examples, and the transitive verb definition have been omitted)

FATHER, n.

1. He who begets a child;

The *father* of a fool hath no joy. Prov. xvii.

A wise son maketh a glad *father*. Prov. x.

2. The first ancestor; the progenitor of a race or family. Adam was the *father* of the human race. Abraham was the *father* of the Israelites.

3. The appellation of an old man, and a term of respect.

The king of Israel said to Elisha, my *father*, shall I smite them? 2 Kings vi.

4. The grandfather, or more remote ancestor. Nebuchadnezzar is called the *father* of Belshazzar, though he was his grand-father. Dan. v.

5. One who feeds and supports, or exercises paternal care over another. God is called the *father* of the fatherless. Ps. lxviii.

6. He who creates, invents, makes or composes any thing; the author, former or contriver; a founder, director or instructor. God as creator is the *father* of all men. John viii. Jabal was the *father* of such as dwell in tents; and Jubal of musicians. Gen. iv. God is the *father* of spirits and lights. Homer is considered as the *father* of epic poetry. Washington, as a defender and an affectionate and wise counselor, is called the *father* of his country. And see I Chron. ii. 51—iv. 14.--ix.35. Satan is called the *father* of lies; he introduced sin, and instigates men to sin. John viii. Abraham is called the *father* of believers. He was an early believer, and a pattern of faith and obedience. Rom. iv.

7. Fathers, in the plural, ancestors.

David slept with his *fathers*. 1 Kings ii.

8. A father in law. So Heli is called the *father* of Joseph. Luke iii.

9. The appellation of the first person in the adorable Trinity.

Go ye, therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the *Father*, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.
Matt. xxviii.

10. The title given to dignitaries of the church, superiors of convents, and to popish confessors.

11. The appellation of the ecclesiastical writers of the first centuries, as Polycarp, Jerome, &c.

12. The title of a senator in ancient Rome; as conscript *fathers*.

Acts 8:9

But there was a certain man, called Simon, which beforetime in the same city used sorcery, and **bewitched** (G1839) the people of Samaria, giving out that himself was some great one:

Acts 8:11

And to him they had regard, because that of long time he had **bewitched** (G1839) them with sorceries.

Galatians 3:1

O foolish Galatians, who hath **bewitched** (G940) you, that ye should not obey the truth, before whose eyes Jesus Christ hath been evidently set forth, crucified among you?

Bewitched: G1839 (2x)	Strong's definition
ἐξίστημι (ex-is'-tay-mee)	ἐξίστημι exístēmi, ex-is'-tay-mee; from G1537 and G2476; to put (stand) out of wits, i.e. astound, or (reflexively) become astounded, insane:—amaze, be (make) astonished, be beside self (selves), bewitch, wonder.

Bewitched: G940 (1x)	Strong's definition
βασκαίνω (bas-kah'-ee-no)	βασκαίνω baskaínō, bas-kah'-ee-no; akin to G5335; to malign, i.e. (by extension) to fascinate (by false representations):—bewitch.

[Merriam-Webster 2023:](#)

bewitched adjective

: controlled or affected by or as if by a magic spell

: influenced, attracted, or charmed as if by magic

bewitch transitive verb

1 a : to influence or affect especially injuriously by witchcraft

b : to cast a spell over

2 : to attract as if by the power of witchcraft : ENCHANT, FASCINATE

intransitive verb

: to bewitch someone or something

[Noah Webster's 1828](#)

BEWITCHED, pp. Fascinated; charmed.

BEWITCH, v.t. To Fascinate;

2. To charm. To fascinate; to please to such a degree as to take away the power of resistance.

3. To deceive and mislead by juggling tricks or imposture. Acts viii. 9

Exodus 25:9

According to all that I shew thee, after the pattern of the **tabernacle**, and the pattern of all the instruments thereof, even so shall ye make it.

NOTE: the English word “tabernacle” appears 297 times in the Bible. 7 Hebrew words are translated to it (H168, H4908, H5520, H5521, H5522, H7900) and 3 Greek words are translated to it (G4633, G4636, G4638). The English word “tabernacles” appears 30 times in the Bible. 3 Hebrew words are translated to it (H168, H4908, H5521). 2 Greek words are translated to it (G4633, G4634).

NOTE: Strong's definitions have been omitted.

[Merriam-Webster 2023:](#)

[Tabernacle](#) noun

1 : a house of worship

specifically : a large building or tent used for evangelistic services

2 : a receptacle for the consecrated elements of the Eucharist

especially : an ornamental locked box used for reserving the Communion hosts

3 a often capitalized : a tent sanctuary used by the Israelites during the Exodus

b archaic : a dwelling place

c archaic : a temporary shelter : TENT

[Tabernacle](#) intransitive verb

: to take up temporary residence

especially : to inhabit a physical body

Synonyms (Noun)

church

kirk [chiefly Scottish]

temple

Example Sentences (Noun)

worshippers gathering at the Baptist tabernacle on a bright Sunday morning

[NOTE: there are no examples provided for the verb form of tabernacle]

Kids Definition

[Tabernacle](#) noun

1 a often capitalized : a tent used as a place of worship by the Israelites during their wanderings in the wilderness with Moses

b archaic : a dwelling place

2 : a locked box used to hold Communion breads

3 : a house of worship

Noah-Webster 1828:

TABERNACLE, n.

1. A tent. Num xxiv. Matt. xvii.
2. A temporary habitation.
3. Among the Jews, a movable building... It is also applied to the temple. Ps xv.
4. A place of worship; a sacred place.
5. Our natural body. 2 Cor. v. 2 Pet. i.
6. God's gracious presence, or the tokens of it. Rev. xxi.
7. An ornamented chest placed on Roman catholic altars as a receptacle of the [ciborium](#) and [pyxis](#).

TABERNACLE, v. i.

To dwell; to reside for a time; to be housed; as we say, Christ tabernacled in the flesh.

Comments

As with all prior words, the reader is encouraged to explore the definitions of the words used to define the primary word being researched (eg. tabernacle → communion → sacrament → consecrate → transubstantiation).